firstplace

About First Place®AZ

First Place AZ is a nonprofit charitable organization established in 2012 with the mission to create a supportive, sustainable community where adults with autism and/or intellectual/developmental disabilities (A/I/DD) live and thrive with pride, purpose and endless possibilities. Our goal is to ensure that housing and community options are as bountiful for special populations as they are for everyone else.

First Place AZ strives to create replicable residential and post-secondary education models that promote private/public/nonprofit/philanthropic collaboration serving as catalysts for advancing public policy focused on housing, healthcare and community solutions. Such advances support local economic development and create opportunities for employment and more independent living for members of this population.









Three primary components

First Place–Phoenix broke ground in December 2016 and opened doors to residents in July 2018 with three primary on-site components:

- **First Place Apartments**—with 55 studio, one-, two- and four-bedroom units for up to 67 residents with A/I/DD—provide access to various services and amenities.
- **First Place Transition Academy**—in collaboration with sister nonprofit Southwest Autism Research & Resource Center (SARRC), offers a two-year, 32-course life skills program—the Learn4Independence® Curriculum—to prepare students for employment and to live more independently.
- **First Place Global Leadership Institute (GLI)** represents a faculty of experts from across the country focused on pressing concerns for accessibility to more quality housing, healthcare and independent living options.

The Global Leadership Insitute

The GLI serves as an international education and training center for educators, researchers, support staff and medical professionals, as well as a robust site for R&D and advancements in public policy.

The GLI's five centers facilitate the critical work and impact of First Place: Maricopa County IDA Center for Education, Training & Employment; Make Waves Center for Community Development; Colonel Harland Sanders Center for Applied Research; Mulzet Center for Expression; and The Daniel Jordan Fiddle Foundation Center for Public Policy.

Learn more at firstplaceaz.org and firstplaceglobal.org

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